Year 3 English | The Broken Invention

Learn and notice | Make the solution fit the problem

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can create a story problem and use connected actions to reach a solution that fits.

The Wobbly Bridge

At the class building challenge, Leo made a cardboard bridge for a toy truck. When he rolled the truck across, the middle bent and the truck slid off.

Leo added more sticky tape, but the bridge still sagged. He looked closely at the empty space underneath. Then he folded two strips of cardboard into sturdy triangles and placed them under the middle.

This time, the truck crossed safely. Leo showed his partner the new supports. Their bridge was ready for the class display.

Writing detective

1. What exactly goes wrong with the bridge?
2. Why might the first attempt fail?
3. How does the successful solution address the problem?

Notice and explain

A. Leo found a magic crown and became king.
B. Leo supported the bending middle and tested the bridge again.
Which ending fits the problem? Explain.

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Year 3 English | The Broken Invention

Think and plan | Make the solution fit the problem

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Your writing task

Write a story about an invention that stops working. Show the problem, an attempt, what the character learns and a connected solution. This is fiction; no real building is required.

Beginning

Who made the invention? What is it meant to do?

Problem

What goes wrong? Be specific rather than saying it is broken.

First attempt

What does the character try? What is the result?

Clue and next action

What do they notice or learn? What change follows?

Solution and ending

Show the invention working or a practical alternative solving the need.

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Write your draft | Use your own ideas

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Your turn

Write a story about an invention that stops working. Show the problem, an attempt, what the character learns and a connected solution. This is fiction; no real building is required.
Useful words: bent, slipped, noticed, supported, tested. Use words only when they fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] I explained what the invention should do.
[ ] The problem is specific.
[ ] The attempts respond to the problem.
[ ] My ending shows whether the solution works.

One focused improvement

Before: The invention broke. Ava fixed it.
After: The cardboard wheel slipped off. Ava noticed its loose clip, fastened it again and tested the wheel.
Find a vague problem or unexplained fix. State what goes wrong and how the action addresses it.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing detective check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I grouped related ideas in paragraphs where useful.
[ ] I can explain one meaningful change.

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Teacher and parent guide | Answers and teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Use two sessions: read/discuss/plan (about 20–25 minutes), then write/revise (about 20–30 minutes). Adjust to the learner. Rehearse orally before writing; supply extra paper if needed. Models are teaching examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

The middle bends and the truck falls off. More tape does not provide enough support underneath; accept reasonable explanations supported by the story. Cardboard supports hold up the middle so the truck can cross.
Notice task: B addresses the bending bridge. A introduces an unrelated solution to a different problem.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Use a simple pretend invention such as a cardboard carrier. Rehearse the failure and repair with drawings.
Challenge: Make the first attempt fail for a clear reason. Use that result to guide the successful attempt.
Ask: What exactly is broken? How would your character know the solution worked?

Record learning and check transfer

For each page 4 skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Give one specific next step and let the child make the change. Record adult prompting or scribing.
Later prompt: The Broken Delivery Cart. Hide the model and check whether the target skill transfers. These are classroom practice criteria, not NAPLAN scores.

Curriculum and preparation scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E3LY06: planning, creating and editing writing, simple paragraphs and language control.
Guided skill practice for NAPLAN preparation; not an official test or score prediction.
Sources: ACARA v9 Year 3 “Narrative - Oceania”; nap.edu.au narrative and persuasive writing guides.

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